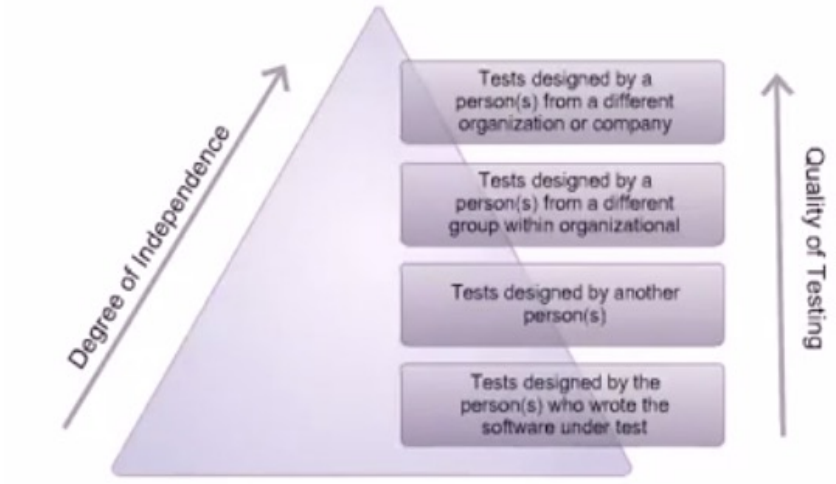
8.1 Test Organisation

5

Degree of Independence



6

Spectrum of Independence

- No independent testers, developers test their own code
- Independent testers within the development teams

Dependent

- Independent test team or group within the organisation, reporting to project management or executive management
- Independent testers from the business organisation or user community

Professional testing department

- Independent test specialists for specific test targets such as usability testers, security testers or certification testers
- Independent testers outsourced or external to the organisation

Independent

7

Benefits of Independence

- Independent testers see other and different defects, and are unbiased
- An independent tester can verify assumptions people made during specification and implementation of the system



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8

Drawbacks of Independence

- Isolation from the development team (if treated as totally independent)
- Developers may lose a sense of responsibility for quality
- Independent testers may be seen as a bottleneck or blamed for delays in release



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9

Tester Organization

- Testers at the component and integration level would be developers
- Testers at the acceptance test level would be business experts and users,
- Testers for operational acceptance testing would be operators.

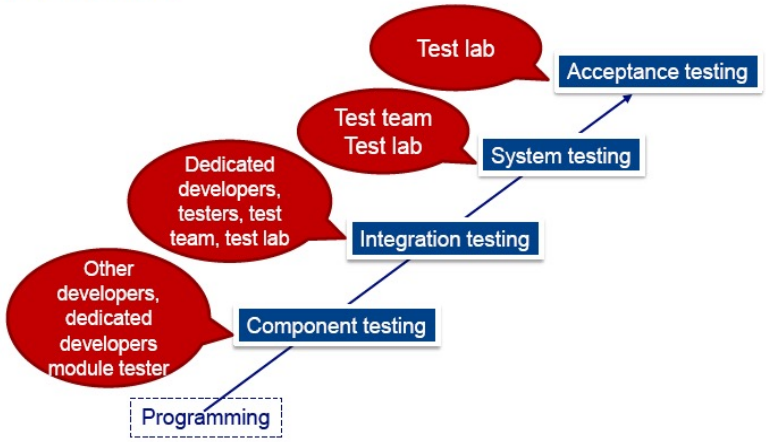


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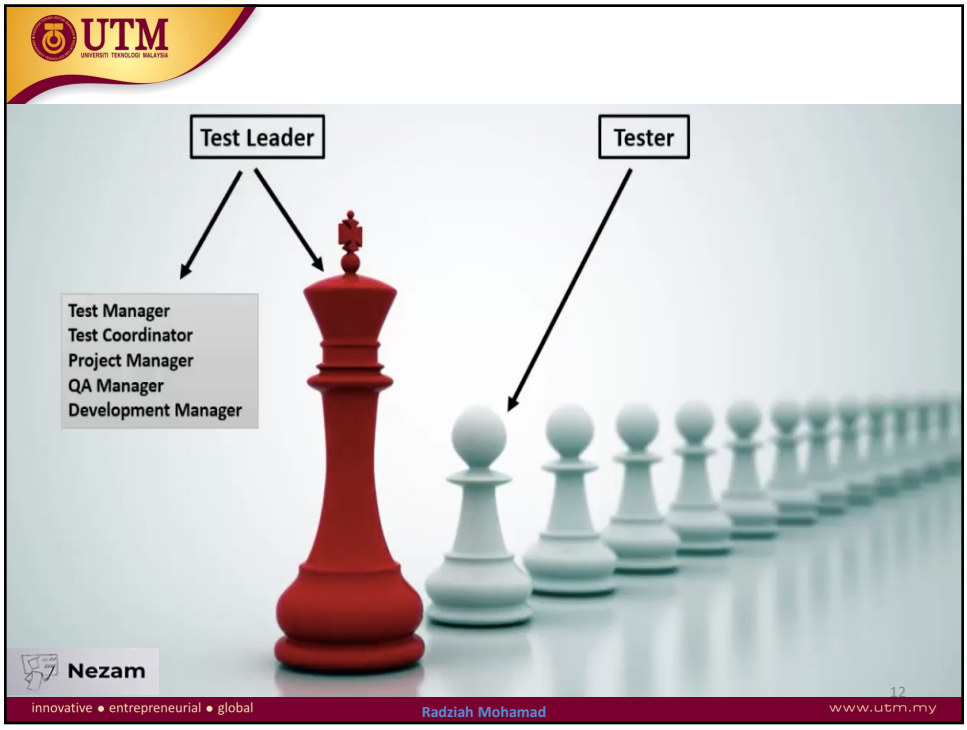
Independence and Test Organisation

Which organizational approach is adequate for which test level?



MSTB/GTB

11



12

Independent Testing

- Test tasks can be taken by people in a specific test role or in a different role
- For example project manager, quality manager, developer, technical and domain expert, staff in infrastructure or IT-department
- Independent testers improve the effectiveness of defect finding

13

Test Leader Tasks

- Plan the tests (approaches-time-effort-cost-resources
- Adapt planning based on test results and progress
- Set up configuration management
- Introduce metrics
- Decide what should be automated
- Select Testing Tools-Test environment
- Monitor Test results-check exit criteria-Write Test Summary Reports



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14

Test Leads / Test Manager

- Devise test strategies, plans
- Write or review test policy
- Consult on testing for other project activities
- Test estimation
- Test resource acquisition
- Lead specification, preparation, implementation and execution of tests
- Monitor and control the test execution
- Adapt the test plan based on test results
- Ensure configuration management of testware
- Ensure traceability
- Measure test progress, evaluate the quality of the testing and the product
- Plan any test automation
- Select tools and organise any tester training
- Ensure implementation of the test environment
- Schedule tests
- Write test summary reports

15

Tester Tasks

- Review and contribute to test plans
  - Review user requirements for testability
  - Set up test environment
  - Prepare test data
  - Implement tests - evaluate the results
  - Automate tests (may be supported by a developer or a test automation expert)
  - Measure performance of components and systems (if applicable)
  - Review tests developed by others



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16

Refining the Tester Position

- Test engineers
  - Technical peers of programmers
  - Chose testing as a specialty
  - Write test cases, organise test suites
  - Create, customise and use advanced test tools
  - Have unique skills
- Test technicians
  - Skilled and experienced tester
  - May be an aspiring test engineer
  - Run tests
  - Report bugs
  - Update test status
  - Assists the test engineers
- Other test team members
  - System and database administrators
  - Release and configuration engineer
  - Test toolsmiths (automation test engineer)